STUDENT ADMISSION ENQUIRY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM USING ZOHO CREATOR

An Undergraduate College Project Report

Developed using the Zoho Creator Low-Code Platform

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1. Introduction

Project Title: Student Admission Enquiry Management System

The Student Admission Enquiry Management System is a low-code application developed using Zoho Creator. It simplifies the collection and management of student admission enquiries.

The system stores student information in one centralized location. It helps administrators track enquiries, manage admission statuses, and automate routine activities such as sending acknowledgements and follow-up reminders.

2. Problem Statement

Traditional admission enquiry management often depends on paper forms and spreadsheets. This approach creates several difficulties:

- Records are scattered and hard to maintain.
- Duplicate or incomplete entries are common.
- Tracking the progress of each student is time-consuming.
- Follow-ups are delayed or forgotten.
- Preparing reports takes extra manual effort.

This project aims to provide a structured, efficient and reliable digital solution to these problems.

3. Objectives

- Collect and organize student enquiry details in a single system.
- Track admission enquiries from the first contact to the final decision.
- Manage admission statuses such as New, Contacted, Interested, Applied, Admitted and Rejected.
- Automate routine tasks such as email notifications and follow-up reminders.
- Reduce paperwork and manual data entry.
- Provide quick reports and dashboards for decision making.

4. Scope of the Project

In scope:

- Online enquiry form for prospective students.
- Secure login for admission staff and administrators.
- Enquiry tracking, status updates and follow-up records.
- Automated email notifications.
- Reports and a summary dashboard.

Out of scope:

- Online payment of application fees.
- Full student record management after admission.
- Document verification and entrance examination modules.

5. About Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator is a low-code platform used to build custom web and mobile applications with minimal programming. Applications are created using forms, reports, pages and workflows.

Reasons for choosing Zoho Creator:

- Quick development using a drag-and-drop interface.
- Built-in database, so no separate setup is required.
- Easy automation through workflows and Deluge scripting.

- Role-based access control for data security.
- Applications run on both web browsers and mobile devices.
- Cloud hosting with no server maintenance.

6. System Requirements

Category	Requirement
Platform	Zoho Creator (cloud-based)
Scripting Language	Deluge (Data Enriched Language for the Universal Grid Environment)
Hardware	Computer or smartphone with internet access
Software	Any modern web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox)
Users	Applicant, Admission Staff, Administrator

7. System Design

7.1 System Overview

The system has three main parts. Students submit enquiries through an online form. The data is saved in the Zoho Creator database. Admission staff then view, update and follow up on the enquiries using reports and dashboards.

Basic flow:

1. Student fills in the enquiry form.
2. The system saves the record and sends an acknowledgement email.
3. Staff review the enquiry and update its status.
4. Follow-up dates are recorded and reminders are sent.
5. The final admission decision is recorded.
6. The administrator views reports and the dashboard.

7.2 User Roles

Role	Responsibilities
Applicant	Submits the enquiry form.
Admission Staff	Views enquiries, updates status, records follow-ups.
Administrator	Manages users, courses and reports; has full access.

7.3 Forms (Database Design)

Form 1: Student Enquiry

Field	Type
Enquiry ID	Auto Number
Student Name	Name
Email	Email
Phone Number	Phone
Date of Birth	Date
Last Qualification and Percentage	Text / Decimal
Course Interested	Lookup (Course form)
City	Text
Source of Enquiry	Dropdown (Website, Social Media, Friend, Advertisement)

Field	Type
Message	Multi-line Text
Status	Dropdown
Enquiry Date	Date-Time (auto)

Form 2: Course

- Course Name
- Duration
- Available Seats

Form 3: Follow-Up

- Enquiry (Lookup)
- Follow-Up Date
- Mode (Call, Email, Visit)
- Remarks
- Next Follow-Up Date

8. Implementation

8.1 Workflows and Automation

- **Acknowledgement Email:** When a new enquiry is submitted, an email is sent to the student automatically.
- **Staff Notification:** Admission staff receive an alert for each new enquiry.
- **Duplicate Check:** The system warns if the same email or phone number already exists.
- **Status Update Email:** The student is informed when the status changes to Applied, Admitted or Rejected.
- **Follow-Up Reminder:** A scheduled workflow sends a daily reminder for follow-ups due that day.

8.2 Validation Rules

- Name, email, phone and course are mandatory fields.
- Phone number must contain valid digits only.
- Email must be in a correct format.
- Percentage must be between 0 and 100.

8.3 Reports and Dashboard

Reports:

- All Enquiries (list view with search and filters)
- Enquiries by Status
- Course-wise Enquiries
- Pending Follow-Ups

Dashboard:

- Total enquiries received
- Status-wise pie chart
- Course-wise bar chart
- Monthly enquiry trend

8.4 Security

- Login is required for staff and administrators.

- Permissions are controlled by role, so staff see only the data they need.
- Zoho Creator provides data encryption and regular backups.

9. Testing

The application was tested using sample data to confirm that each function works correctly.

Test Case	Expected Result	Result
Submit form with all valid details	Record saved; email sent	Pass
Submit form with a blank mandatory field	Error message displayed	Pass
Enter an existing email address	Duplicate warning shown	Pass
Change status to Admitted	Status saved; student notified	Pass
Login with a wrong password	Access denied	Pass
Open the dashboard	Charts display correct counts	Pass

10. Advantages of the System

- Centralized and organized storage of all enquiries.
- Saves time by reducing manual work.
- Timely follow-ups improve the chance of admission.
- Fewer errors compared to paper and spreadsheets.
- Real-time reports support better planning.
- Easy to modify and extend because of the low-code platform.
- Accessible from anywhere through the internet.

11. Limitations

- Requires a stable internet connection.
- Depends on the Zoho Creator platform and its subscription plan.
- Does not currently include online fee payment or document upload verification.

12. Future Enhancements

- SMS and WhatsApp notifications.
- Online application form and document upload.
- Online payment of application fees.
- Integration with Zoho CRM for lead management.
- Chatbot to answer common admission questions.
- Advanced analytics to study enquiry sources and conversion rates.

13. Conclusion

The Student Admission Enquiry Management System successfully replaces manual enquiry handling with a simple digital solution. It stores data securely, tracks every enquiry, and automates routine communication. The project also shows how a low-code platform like Zoho Creator can be used to build useful business applications quickly. With the planned enhancements, the system can grow into a complete admission management solution for the institution.

14. References

- Zoho Creator Help Documentation – help.zoho.com/portal/en/community/creator
- Zoho Creator Deluge Scripting Guide – deluge.zoho.com
- Zoho Creator Official Website – zoho.com/creator

Appendix: Case Study – Admission Enquiry Handling at a Sample Arts and Science College

Note: This is an illustrative case study. The college name and figures are sample data used to demonstrate how the system works.

A. Background

ABC Arts and Science College is a mid-sized college offering ten undergraduate programmes. Every year, the admission office receives about 3,000 enquiries between April and July through walk-ins, phone calls, the college website and social media.

B. Challenges Faced

Before the project, the admission office used paper registers and Excel sheets. This led to the following problems:

- Enquiries from different sources were recorded in different places.
- About 15% of entries were duplicates or had wrong phone numbers.
- Staff could not easily see which students had already been contacted.
- Follow-up calls were missed during the peak admission season.
- Preparing a weekly report for the principal took nearly one full day.
- Students received no confirmation after submitting an enquiry.

C. Solution Implemented

The college adopted the Student Admission Enquiry Management System built on Zoho Creator.

- The online enquiry form was placed on the college website and shared through a QR code on posters and social media pages.
- Walk-in and phone enquiries were entered by staff using the same form, so all records stayed in one database.
- Each enquiry was given a status and an assigned staff member.
- Automated emails were sent to students and staff.
- A dashboard was set up for the principal and admission head.

D. Implementation Steps

Step	Activity
1	Studied the existing admission process and listed required data fields.
2	Created the Student Enquiry, Course and Follow-Up forms.
3	Added validation rules and the duplicate check.
4	Built workflows for email notifications and follow-up reminders.
5	Created reports and the dashboard.
6	Assigned roles and permissions to staff.
7	Tested with sample data and trained the admission staff.
8	Went live at the start of the admission season.

E. Sample Enquiry Journey

1. A student, Priya, scans the QR code and submits an enquiry for the B.Sc. Computer Science course.
2. She instantly receives an acknowledgement email with her Enquiry ID.
3. The system assigns the enquiry to a staff member and sends an alert.
4. The staff member calls Priya the next day, records the call in the Follow-Up form, and changes the status to *Interested*.

5. A reminder is sent three days later for the next follow-up.
6. Priya applies and the status becomes *Applied*, then *Admitted*.
7. The dashboard updates the course-wise and status-wise counts automatically.

F. Results (Sample Comparison)

Measure	Before the System	After the System
Time to record one enquiry	5–6 minutes	1–2 minutes
Duplicate or wrong entries	About 15%	Below 2%
Follow-ups completed on time	About 50%	About 90%
Time to prepare weekly report	1 day	A few seconds (live dashboard)
Student acknowledgement	None	Immediate email

G. Key Benefits Observed

- Better organization, since all enquiries were stored in one place.
- Faster response to students, which improved their experience.
- Higher conversion of enquiries into admissions because of timely follow-ups.
- Clear visibility for management through live reports.
- Lower paperwork and workload for staff.

H. Lessons Learned

- Clear data fields and validation rules at the start prevent data quality problems later.
- Staff training is as important as the application itself.
- Starting with a simple version and adding features later works well on a low-code platform.

I. Case Study Conclusion

This case study shows that a low-code solution built on Zoho Creator can improve the speed, accuracy and transparency of admission enquiry handling. The same approach can be applied to other colleges and institutions with small changes to the forms and workflows.